

Model Kolkata

In Haute Pursuit

To appear on the
Oprah Winfrey Show

At 5 ft 8 inches, Ushoshi Sengupta, 21, stands tall. She dreams big too. "My dad once had to knock on the bathroom door and ask who I was talking to. I told him I was doing the Oprah show. He told me to go ahead and dream," she says. Fresh from the Kolkata auditions of the Miss India pageant for the eastern region, Sengupta is already hot property in West Bengal's fashion circuit. "There were 50 of us who had been shortlisted. The judges asked me questions on confidence and why I was choosing beauty as a career. I answered the questions and was happy to see myself as one of the eight finalists," she says. She can already see the crown on her head and has rehearsed the winning speech.

Born in Delhi, Sengupta spent seven years in Vadodara. Besides being the first runner-up in the Tilottama Beauty Queen contest in Kolkata in 2008, the biggest style honour in the city, she has also been the brand ambassador of the Lakme Fashion Week in Kolkata. The dusky beauty has walked the ramp for designers Kiran Uttam Ghosh, Anamika Khanna and Dev r Nil. If this wasn't a reason enough to be confident, Sengupta also believes that her father having been in the Air Force may be a lucky omen. "Sushmita Sen and Priyanka Chopra have defence backgrounds. If that is a link to be born with, well, here I come," she says. The social networking bug has also bitten the Bengali beauty as she admits putting pictures diligently on Facebook and Orkut. But this doesn't take her

"Straitjacket is out. Doing talent-oriented work is in. All of us must think beyond 9-to-5 jobs."

USHOSHI SENGUPTA

Model, Miss India aspirant

away from her dream of going to Mumbai and making a mark as a glamazon. Her younger sister may want to become a nurse, but for her a nine-to-five job is a thing of the past. "Forget MBAS. It's for fossils and spreadsheets are for dinosaurs," she says, adding with the wisdom of youth. "Remember, you are always more talented than your boss. So be one yourself." Her father, who dropped out at 19 to join the IAF, couldn't agree more. **by Abhijit Dasgupta**

